

Contractor's Initial Response — Defect Notice ENG-NRB4-0078

Nandira River Bridge Project — Package NRB-4

Document Reference: CTR-NRB4-0162
Date: 04-Mar-2024
Contract No.: NHIA/NRB4/CW/2020-01
From: Contractor, Quality Manager, Sagara Constructions Pvt. Ltd.
To: Engineer, Meridian Engineering Consultants

Subject: Initial Response — Defect Notice ENG-NRB4-0078, Pier P2 Pier Cap

We acknowledge Defect Notice ENG-NRB4-0078 dated 20-Feb-2024 and confirm we will investigate the cracking reported at the Pier P2 pier cap in accordance with Sub-Clause 11.1, and will not undertake remedial work pending the Engineer's instruction.

Our preliminary, without-prejudice view, based on a site walk carried out 01-Mar-2024, is that the cracking is consistent with plastic or early-age drying shrinkage arising from the ambient conditions prevailing at the time of the pour on 11-Aug-2021, a period of elevated daytime temperatures on Site, and is not attributable to any deficiency in materials or workmanship. We note the concrete mix used for this pour was the same approved Grade M40 mix design used successfully across all other substructure elements on the Works.

We propose to engage Suvarna Materials Testing Laboratory, the independent testing laboratory already nominated by the Engineer for the Works, to carry out crack mapping, core testing, and non-destructive testing to establish the extent and cause of the cracking, and will report our root cause analysis in accordance with the timetable in ENG-NRB4-0078.

We reserve our position as to liability for the cost of any remedial work pending that investigation.

Regards,
Quality Manager
Sagara Constructions Pvt. Ltd.